

* **Select the option that best replaces the bold phrase.**

1. Idiomatic Noun Forms & Expressions

1. In lieu of the fresh forensic evidence, the tribunal has agreed to reopen the hearing.

- (1) In place of
- (2) In light of
- (3) In default of
- (4) No replacement needed

2. The department's own figures militate against the claim that the collapse could not have been foreseen.

- (1) mitigate against
- (2) mitigate
- (3) militate
- (4) No replacement needed

3. The sheer enormousness of the killings kept three districts under curfew for six weeks.

- (1) enormous nature
- (2) enormousness of it
- (3) enormity
- (4) No replacement needed

4. Successive state governments have flaunted the court's directions on crop burning without once being held in contempt.

- (1) flouted
- (2) flaunted at
- (3) vaunted
- (4) No replacement needed

5. The loose drafting of the terms of reference gave the chairman a free reign over what the inquiry would and would not examine.

- (1) the free reign
- (2) free reins
- (3) a free rein
- (4) No replacement needed

6. What the memorandum presents as a concession is, on any honest reading, a distinction without a difference.

- (1) a difference without distinction
- (2) a distinctive difference
- (3) a distinction of no difference
- (4) No replacement needed

7. The state's water policy and its industrial policy have been at cross purpose to each other for the better part of a decade.

- (1) at cross purposes with
- (2) in cross purposes with
- (3) at crossed purposes with

- (4) No replacement needed
8. A single dissenting note **casts doubts upon** the unanimity that the press release claims.
- (1) casts a doubt upon
 - (2) throws doubts at
 - (3) casts doubt on
 - (4) No replacement needed
9. The witness's statement and the call records are **at variance to** each other on the crucial half-hour.
- (1) at variance with
 - (2) in variance with
 - (3) at variance from
 - (4) No replacement needed
10. The decree was passed **in absentia**, the respondent having been served only at an address he had left in 2019.
- (1) in absentee
 - (2) in the absentia
 - (3) on absentia
 - (4) No replacement needed

2. Phrasal Verbs & Prepositional Combination

1. The chief merit of the scheme **consists of** its simplicity, not in the size of the subsidy it offers.
- (1) is consisted of
 - (2) consists in
 - (3) consists with
 - (4) No replacement needed
2. Two members of the panel **differ from** the chairman on the interpretation of clause 14.
- (1) differ against
 - (2) differ over
 - (3) differ with
 - (4) No replacement needed
3. Counsel **prevailed over** the bench to take the application out of turn.
- (1) prevailed upon
 - (2) prevailed against
 - (3) prevailed for
 - (4) No replacement needed
4. The department has been **sitting over** the file since March without recording a single note.
- (1) sitting with
 - (2) sitting through
 - (3) sitting on
 - (4) No replacement needed

5. The delay was **put down as** poor coordination between two wings of the same office.

- (1) put down for
- (2) put down to
- (3) put down against
- (4) No replacement needed

6. Her account **squares with** the CCTV timeline in every material respect.

- (1) squares to
- (2) squares up with
- (3) is squared by
- (4) No replacement needed

7. The union has **gone back from** its undertaking not to strike during the harvest.

- (1) gone back over
- (2) gone back against
- (3) gone back on
- (4) No replacement needed

8. The vice-chancellor **came in for** sharp criticism over the delay in declaring the results.

- (1) came up for
- (2) came in of
- (3) came under for
- (4) No replacement needed

9. The commission **set great store on** the evidence of a single retired clerk.

- (1) set great store by
- (2) set great stores by
- (3) laid great store on
- (4) No replacement needed

10. He was **passed over for** promotion twice before he finally applied elsewhere.

- (1) passed up for
- (2) passed over from
- (3) passed by for
- (4) No replacement needed

3. Infinitive Adjustments

1. I distinctly remember **to lock** the strong-room before I left on Friday.

- (1) to be locking
- (2) locking
- (3) to have been locking
- (4) No replacement needed

2. The registrar's office regrets **to inform** you that your application has been rejected.

- (1) informing
- (2) to be informing

- (3) to have informed
(4) No replacement needed
3. The accused is said **to be** at his sister's house in Surat on the night of the incident.
(1) to have been
(2) to have being
(3) that he was
(4) No replacement needed
4. We would rather they **did not raise** the matter at the general body meeting.
(1) do not raise
(2) not to raise
(3) would not raise
(4) No replacement needed
5. The principal had the peon **to lock** the gate before the results were put up.
(1) locking
(2) locked
(3) lock
(4) No replacement needed
6. She is believed **to be working** on the manuscript for the last twelve years.
(1) to have been working
(2) to be worked
(3) to have been worked
(4) No replacement needed
7. The auditors recommended that the accounts **are restated** for both financial years.
(1) should be restating
(2) were restated
(3) be restated
(4) No replacement needed
8. The delegates were made **wait** in the lobby for the better part of an hour.
(1) waiting
(2) to wait
(3) to waiting
(4) No replacement needed
9. Nothing remains now but **to await** the tribunal's order.
(1) awaiting
(2) await
(3) to awaiting
(4) No replacement needed
10. He denied **to have taken** any money from the contractor.
(1) that he takes
(2) having taken

- (3) to take
- (4) No replacement needed

4. Inversion Structures

1. Only when the third audit was commissioned **the scale of the diversion became** clear.
 - (1) had the scale of the diversion become
 - (2) the scale of the diversion did become
 - (3) did the scale of the diversion become
 - (4) No replacement needed
2. Not until the file reached the secretariat **anyone noticed** that two pages were missing.
 - (1) did anyone notice
 - (2) had anyone noticed
 - (3) anyone did notice
 - (4) No replacement needed
3. Hardly had the ink dried on the settlement **before** the first violation was reported.
 - (1) than
 - (2) when
 - (3) that
 - (4) No replacement needed
4. **No sooner had the tanker overturned when** the highway was closed in both directions.
 - (1) No sooner the tanker had overturned than
 - (2) No sooner did the tanker overturn when
 - (3) No sooner had the tanker overturned than
 - (4) No replacement needed
5. In no time at all **had the hall filled** to capacity.
 - (1) the hall had filled
 - (2) did the hall fill
 - (3) was the hall filling
 - (4) No replacement needed
6. Not long after the merger was announced, **three directors resigned** without explanation.
 - (1) did three directors resign
 - (2) three directors did resign
 - (3) resigned three directors
 - (4) No replacement needed
7. **Such the confusion was** that the count had to be abandoned twice.
 - (1) So the confusion was
 - (2) Such was the confusion
 - (3) Such was confusion
 - (4) No replacement needed

8. Nor **the ministry has issued** any clarification in the nine months since.
- (1) has the ministry issued
 - (2) the ministry did issue
 - (3) has issued the ministry
 - (4) No replacement needed
9. Only the registrar **can sign** a transfer certificate in the principal's absence.
- (1) can the registrar sign
 - (2) the registrar can sign
 - (3) is able the registrar to sign
 - (4) No replacement needed
10. Had the survey been completed on schedule, the department **would not have been** in this position today.
- (1) would not be
 - (2) will not be
 - (3) would have not been
 - (4) No replacement needed

* Select the option that best replaces the bold phrase.

1. Idiomatic Noun Forms & Expressions

1. **In lieu of** the fresh forensic evidence, the tribunal has agreed to reopen the hearing.

- (1) In place of
- (2) **In light of**
- (3) In default of
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: In lieu of means "instead of"; the fresh evidence is the ground for reopening the hearing, not a substitute for it. In default of means "in the absence of", which reverses the sense.

2. The department's own figures **militate against** the claim that the collapse could not have been foreseen.

- (1) mitigate against
- (2) mitigate
- (3) militate
- (4) **No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. Militate against = weigh against, tell against. Mitigate means "make less severe" and takes a direct object; mitigate against is a widespread malapropism and is the intended trap.

3. The sheer **enormousness** of the killings kept three districts under curfew for six weeks.

- (1) enormous nature
- (2) enormousness of it
- (3) **enormity**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Enormity denotes great wickedness or moral outrage; enormousness denotes mere physical size and cannot collocate with an atrocity.

4. Successive state governments have **flaunted** the court's directions on crop burning without once being held in contempt.

- (1) **flouted**
- (2) flaunted at
- (3) vaunted
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Flout = openly disobey; flaunt = display ostentatiously; vaunt = boast of. Only flout takes court directions as its object in this sense.

5. The loose drafting of the terms of reference gave the chairman **a free reign** over what the inquiry would and would not examine.

- (1) the free reign
- (2) free reins
- (3) **a free rein**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: The metaphor is equestrian: rein, not reign. The indefinite article is retained and the noun stays singular in the fixed idiom.

6. What the memorandum presents as a concession is, on any honest reading, **a distinction without a difference**.

- (1) a difference without distinction
- (2) a distinctive difference
- (3) a distinction of no difference
- (4) No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. The formula is fixed as a distinction without a difference; each alternative breaks either the word order or the article.

7. The state's water policy and its industrial policy have been **at cross purpose to** each other for the better part of a decade.

- (1) at cross purposes with**
- (2) in cross purposes with
- (3) at crossed purposes with
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: The idiom is plural and takes with: at cross purposes with. Neither the singular purpose nor the participial crossed is licensed.

8. A single dissenting note **casts doubts upon** the unanimity that the press release claims.

- (1) casts a doubt upon
- (2) throws doubts at
- (3) casts doubt on**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Doubt is uncountable in this collocation and the preposition is on. Casts doubts upon over-pluralises the noun and mis-selects the preposition.

9. The witness's statement and the call records are **at variance to** each other on the crucial half-hour.

- (1) at variance with**
- (2) in variance with
- (3) at variance from
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: At variance with is the fixed collocation; from and to are analogical errors imported from different from and contrary to.

10. The decree was passed **in absentia**, the respondent having been served only at an address he had left in 2019.

- (1) in absentee
- (2) in the absentia
- (3) on absentia
- (4) No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. In absentia is a Latin adverbial phrase: it takes no article and admits no substituted preposition.

2. Phrasal Verbs & Prepositional Combination

1. The chief merit of the scheme **consists of** its simplicity, not in the size of the subsidy it offers.

- (1) is consisted of
- (2) **consists in**
- (3) consists with
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Consist in = have as its essence; consist of = be composed of. The parallel clause "not in the size of the subsidy" supplies the internal evidence for in.

2. Two members of the panel **differ from** the chairman on the interpretation of clause 14.

- (1) differ against
- (2) differ over
- (3) **differ with**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Differ from = be unlike; differ with (a person) = disagree with them. The object here is a person holding a view, so with is required.

3. Counsel **prevailed over** the bench to take the application out of turn.

- (1) **prevailed upon**
- (2) prevailed against
- (3) prevailed for
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Prevail upon or on = persuade; prevail over = defeat, get the better of. The sense required is persuasion, not victory.

4. The department has been **sitting over** the file since March without recording a single note.

- (1) sitting with
- (2) sitting through
- (3) **sitting on**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Sit on a file = delay acting on it. Sitting over is an Indian English calque and is the target error of the item.

5. The delay was **put down as** poor coordination between two wings of the same office.

- (1) put down for
- (2) **put down to**
- (3) put down against
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Put something down to X = attribute it to X. Put down as means classify as, and is used of persons or types, not of abstract causes.

6. Her account **squares with** the CCTV timeline in every material respect.

- (1) squares to
- (2) squares up with
- (3) is squared by
- (4) **No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. Square with = be consistent with; square up with means settle a debt with, which does not fit a timeline.

7. The union has **gone back from** its undertaking not to strike during the harvest.

- (1) gone back over
- (2) gone back against
- (3) **gone back on**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Go back on an undertaking = fail to honour it. From, over and against are unattested with this sense.

8. The vice-chancellor **came in for** sharp criticism over the delay in declaring the results.

- (1) came up for
- (2) came in of
- (3) came under for
- (4) **No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. Come in for criticism = be subjected to it; come up for means be due for consideration.

9. The commission **set great store on** the evidence of a single retired clerk.

- (1) **set great store by**
- (2) set great stores by
- (3) laid great store on
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: The idiom is set great store by. On, in and to are the common substitutions and all three are wrong; store also stays singular.

10. He was **passed over for** promotion twice before he finally applied elsewhere.

- (1) passed up for
- (2) passed over from
- (3) passed by for
- (4) **No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. Pass someone over for promotion = overlook them; pass up means decline an opportunity, which reverses the agency.

3. Infinitive Adjustments

1. I distinctly remember **to lock** the strong-room before I left on Friday.

- (1) to be locking
- (2) **locking**
- (3) to have been locking
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Remember + -ing reports a past act recalled; remember + to-infinitive reports a duty still to be discharged. The past-time frame forces the gerund.

2. The registrar's office regrets **to inform** you that your application has been rejected.

- (1) informing
- (2) to be informing
- (3) to have informed
- (4) **No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. Regret to inform is the fixed performative for delivering bad news at the moment of writing; regret + -ing would report remorse for an earlier act.

3. The accused is said **to be** at his sister's house in Surat on the night of the incident.

- (1) **to have been**
- (2) to have being
- (3) that he was
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: The reported event precedes the reporting verb, so the perfect infinitive is obligatory. A that-clause is impossible after is said in this raising structure.

4. We would rather they **did not raise** the matter at the general body meeting.

- (1) do not raise
- (2) not to raise
- (3) would not raise
- (4) **No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. Would rather + subject takes the past subjunctive for present or future reference.

5. The principal had the peon **to lock** the gate before the results were put up.

- (1) locking
- (2) locked
- (3) **lock**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Causative have takes a bare infinitive: had the peon lock the gate. Contrast make, which takes the to-infinitive in the passive (item 8).

6. She is believed **to be working** on the manuscript for the last twelve years.

- (1) **to have been working**
- (2) to be worked
- (3) to have been worked
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: The adjunct "for the last twelve years" requires a perfect form, and the activity is continuing, so the perfect progressive infinitive is required.

7. The auditors recommended that the accounts **are restated** for both financial years.

- (1) should be restating
- (2) were restated
- (3) **be restated**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Recommend that governs the mandative subjunctive: the base form, with no tense or number agreement.

8. The delegates were made **wait** in the lobby for the better part of an hour.

- (1) waiting
- (2) **to wait**
- (3) to waiting
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Make takes a bare infinitive in the active but a to-infinitive in the passive. This is the most productive trap in the sub-section.

9. Nothing remains now but **to await** the tribunal's order.

- (1) awaiting
- (2) await
- (3) to awaiting
- (4) **No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. After nothing remains but, the to-infinitive is required; the bare infinitive follows only cannot but and do nothing but.

10. He denied **to have taken** any money from the contractor.

- (1) that he takes
- (2) **having taken**
- (3) to take
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Deny takes a gerund, never an infinitive; anteriority is marked by the perfect gerund having taken.

4. Inversion Structures

1. Only when the third audit was commissioned **the scale of the diversion became** clear.

- (1) had the scale of the diversion become
- (2) the scale of the diversion did become
- (3) **did the scale of the diversion become**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: A fronted only-adverbial inverts the main clause, not the subordinate one. The operator did carries the tense and the lexical verb stays in the base form.

2. Not until the file reached the secretariat **anyone noticed** that two pages were missing.

- (1) **did anyone notice**
- (2) had anyone noticed
- (3) anyone did notice
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: The same rule applies after not until: the operator carries the past tense, so notice remains uninflected.

3. Hardly had the ink dried on the settlement **before** the first violation was reported.

- (1) than
- (2) **when**
- (3) that
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: The correlatives are hardly ... when, scarcely ... when and no sooner ... than. Before is not licensed by hardly.

4. **No sooner had the tanker overturned when** the highway was closed in both directions.

- (1) No sooner the tanker had overturned than
- (2) No sooner did the tanker overturn when
- (3) No sooner had the tanker overturned than**
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Two faults are corrected at once: no sooner requires subject-operator inversion, and its correlative is than, not when.

5. In no time at all **had the hall filled** to capacity.

- (1) the hall had filled**
- (2) did the hall fill
- (3) was the hall filling
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: In no time is a positive time adjunct, not a negative adverbial, and triggers no inversion. The item tests over-application of the inversion rule.

6. Not long after the merger was announced, **three directors resigned** without explanation.

- (1) did three directors resign
- (2) three directors did resign
- (3) resigned three directors
- (4) No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. Not long after introduces a subordinate clause; the main clause that follows keeps normal subject-verb order.

7. **Such the confusion was** that the count had to be abandoned twice.

- (1) So the confusion was
- (2) Such was the confusion**
- (3) Such was confusion
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: In the such ... that construction, such is fronted and the copula inverts with the subject.

8. Nor **the ministry has issued** any clarification in the nine months since.

- (1) has the ministry issued**
- (2) the ministry did issue
- (3) has issued the ministry
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: Clause-initial nor obligatorily inverts, and it is the operator has, not the lexical verb, that precedes the subject.

9. Only the registrar **can sign** a transfer certificate in the principal's absence.

- (1) can the registrar sign
- (2) the registrar can sign
- (3) is able the registrar to sign
- (4) No replacement needed**

Reason: Correct as printed. Only + subject does not invert; inversion follows only when it modifies an adverbial, as in items 1 and 2.

10. Had the survey been completed on schedule, the department **would not have been** in this position today.

- (1) **would not be**
- (2) will not be
- (3) would have not been
- (4) No replacement needed

Reason: The condition is past but the consequence is present, as "today" shows, so a mixed conditional is required.